Case 02 – Snapped Phish-ing Line

1. Alert Summary

Alert Type: Phishing Email

Severity: High

Initial Detection: 29 June 2020

2. Email Analysis

Sender: `Accounts.Payable@groupmarketingonline.icu`

Recipient: `zoe.duncan@swiftspend.finance`

Subject: `Direct Credit Advice`

Date: `29 June 2020`

3. Header Analysis

SPF: Pass

DKIM: Pass

DMARC: Pass

Source IP: External IP address associated with the sending infrastructure

Note: SPF/DKIM/DMARC passing does not automatically mean an email is legitimate. The attacker can send from infrastructure with properly configured authentication.

4. Email Content Analysis

What did the attacker claim?

The attacker impersonated a legitimate business/payment-related communication and presented the email as a credit/payment advice or financial document.

What was suspicious?

• Unexpected financial-related email.

• Sender domain was suspicious: groupmarketingonline.icu

• Email contained an HTML attachment.

• Attachment contained a phishing/redirection URL.

• The URL redirected the victim to attacker-controlled infrastructure.

• The attachment was designed to collect credentials.

5. Attachment / URL Analysis

Attachment: `Direct Credit Advice.html`

URL:

```
http://kennaroads.buzz/data/Update365/office365/40e7baa2f826a57fcf04e5202526f8bd/?email=zoe.duncan@swiftspend.finance&error
```

Root Domain: `kennaroads.buzz`

The /data directory exposed a phishing-kit archive, which contained submit.php.

6. IOC Analysis

Type	Indicator	Description
Sender domain	groupmarketingonline.icu	Suspicious sender domain
Phishing domain	kennaroads.buzz	Attacker-controlled phishing infrastructure
Recipient	zoe.duncan@swiftspend.finance	Targeted recipient
Attachment	Direct Credit Advice.html	Malicious HTML attachment
Archive	Update365.zip	Phishing-kit archive
File	submit.php	Credential collection script
Email	m3npat@yandex.com	Attacker collection email

7. Threat Intelligence

VirusTotal / IP / Domain results:

The domain kennaroads.buzz was identified as suspicious/malicious infrastructure associated with the phishing campaign.

The HTML attachment and exposed phishing kit provided additional evidence that the domain was being used for credential phishing.

8. MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

Technique: T1566.001 – Spearphishing Attachment

Evidence: The attacker sent a targeted email containing the malicious Direct Credit Advice.html attachment. Opening the attachment redirected the victim to attacker-controlled infrastructure.

Additional technique: T1056.002 – Input Capture: GUI Input Capture

Evidence: The phishing kit was designed to capture credentials submitted by the victim and send them to the attacker's email address.

9. Conclusion

The email was considered phishing because it used a financial-themed message to make the victim trust the communication and included an HTML attachment containing a malicious redirection URL. The redirection led to attacker-controlled infrastructure containing a phishing kit designed to steal user credentials. The exposed submit.php file showed that compromised credentials were collected by the attacker.

10. Recommended Response

✓ Quarantine the phishing email.

✓ Block IOCs such as kennaroads.buzz and groupmarketingonline.icu.

✓ Search for similar emails across the organization.

✓ Check whether the user opened the attachment/link.

✓ If credentials were entered, reset the user's password immediately.

✓ Revoke active sessions/tokens if applicable.

✓ Review authentication logs for suspicious logins.

✓ Add the malicious domains and URLs to security controls/blocklists.